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(ASSIGNMENT No. 02)

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BCS-2A

Q.) Evaluate how the speaker William Jefferson Clinton employs rhetorical strategies (such as ethos, pathos and logos). How do these choices help the speaker achieve their purpose (such as, persuading the audience, creating a sense of unity or provoking thoughts)?

ANALYSIS OF WILLIAM JEFFERSON CLINTON'S RHETORICAL STRATEGIES

Introduction:-

Former President William Jefferson Clinton uses, ethos, pathos and logos in his speech about the Oklahoma City bombing disaster to comfort the nation in mourning, bring the audience together, and advocate for justice and resiliency. In the face of destruction, he wants to offer consolation, promote harmony and arouse hope.

1) Ethos:- Clinton establishes his trust and credibility in several ways:

a) PERSONAL CONNECTION:

As a parent and neighbor, he says, "Hillary and I also come as parents, as husbands and wife, as people who were your neighbour for some of the best years of our lives." This makes his message more relatable and fosters trust.

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REPRESENTATIVE RULE:-

In his capacity as President, he says, "I am honoured to be here today to represent the American people."

MORALITY AND AUTHORITY:-

He affirms his morality by using scripture (such as psalms and St. Paul) and reference to common beliefs and values.

RESULT: By making these decisions, Clinton is able to establish a strong connection with the audience and make sure they see him as a sympathetic leader and fellow mourner.

2) PATHOS:-

Clinton heavily relies on pathos to evoke empathy and solidarity.

SHARED GRIEF:

"Today, our country shares your sorrow. We share your grief. As a result, everyone feels a sense of loss."

In order to increase emotional impact, he humanizes the victims by referring to them as "good parents", "innocent children" and public servants. The widow of Pan Am 103 adds a moving and personal aspects to the story in her letter, which reads,

"The anger you feel is valid, but you must not allow yourself to be consumed by it."

RESULT:

These pleas reassure the audience, affirm their feelings and promote fortitude.

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3) LOGOS:-

Despite the speech's strong emotional content, Clinton uses reason to support his points:

CALL TO ACTION:

He exhorts pragmatists to "stand against hatred and violence", "purge ourselves of the dark forces", and "teach our children values."

JUSTICE AND LEGACY:

The statements "their legacy must be our lines" and "justice will prevail" present the reaction to tragedy as a logical obligation. In his quote, Governor Keating highlights Oklahoma's tenacity as proof of America's enduring might.

RESULT:

These rational arguments offer a clear course of actions that strike a balance between purpose and emotions.

CONCLUSION:

Clinton's strategic use of pathos, ethos and logos allow him to achieve multiple purpose.

The speech exemplifies how ~~set~~ rhetorical strategies can heal and mobilize a community in crisis. Clinton's blend of personal empathy, moral authority and logical resolve makes his message both powerful and enduring.